



Figure 1: The desktop after some customisation

hardware was detected and configured properly without any manual configuration. I have a Logitech wireless keyboard and mouse combo, which was detected during installation.

I chose KDE as the default desktop. Other desktop environments are also available like GNOME 3.16.2, XFCE 4.12.1 and Mate 1.10.

Post-installation software

After installation, I rebooted into an all-new KDE 5/Plasma 5 desktop. openSUSE has the best implementation of KDE. It runs smoothly. The new Plasma desktop looks very sleek and shiny. It is very responsive and applications open very quickly; Dolphin opened in a second and Google Chrome starts faster than on previous openSUSE releases. The dark theme look is much more consistent across the system. Some long-pending issues have been resolved in Plasma 5, like power management now recognises video playing on VLC and does not dim the screen. It also recognises YouTube video playing in the browser.

Bluetooth did not work well — I was able to connect Bluetooth speakers the first time but did not get any sound. And when I tried to reconnect, the system couldn't find them even though they were placed right next to the laptop. So the blue devil is still very buggy. The second issue I faced was with the wallet manager — I was not able to disable it. KDE Control Centre doesn't have an option for the wallet manager. There is a separate application for the wallet manager which does not respond to any action, so you can't disable it.

There are plenty of applications available in default repos; if not, then these must be in the OBS (openSUSE build

service) repo. For installing VLC and other multimedia apps, you need to add the *packman* repo (it is not an OBS repo).

I tried installing Filezilla, but it is not available in the default repos. I searched on <http://software.opensuse.org> and found it in a few other repos, and chose to install it from the network repo. Similarly, I found MonoDevelop in the Mono Factory repo; both packages were earlier in default repos. For a stable environment like a server or enterprise desktop, it is not a good idea to add a factory repo.

The all-new openSUSE Leap is a solid, very stable release — more so than previous releases. KDE 5 is not completely ready, though the Plasma desktop is good. Yet, many KDE applications are being ported and still have bugs. Some of the packages are not in default repos, which they were earlier. I hope this will be fixed soon.

From now onwards, SUSE will take care of openSUSE Core; so I am sure that over a few releases, it will mature into an enterprise-class OS that can be used for desktops and servers alike. It will benefit the community also.

As some resources get freed from taking care of openSUSE Core, we will surely see some improvement in community contributions and Tumblweed will get more love. In my opinion, OpenQA played an important role in improving the overall quality of the distribution. 

By: Sharique Ahmed Farooqui

The author works as a senior consultant (Drupal) at Capgemini. He is an active contributor to Drupal and an active member of the Pune Drupal community. He occasionally contributes to other open source communities and blogs at <http://openahmed.com>